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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Directive on admissions data rattles universities

Could increase legal, political risk for local schools, experts say

By Kate Armanini
Chicago Tribune

A new memo from the Trump administration may undercut universities' efforts to pursue a diverse student body, the latest move in the president's sweeping crackdown on diversity, equity and inclusion initiatives roiling Chicago-area schools.

The directive, issued earlier this month, requires institutions to hand over race-based admissions data.

Though the Supreme Court struck down affirmative action in 2023, universities can still legally use race-neutral strategies to seek out diversity — such as adopting test-optional policies or including essay prompts about applicants' backgrounds. But President Donald Trump's mandate may undermine that holistic review process, potentially increasing the legal and political risks for local universities, experts say.

"This builds on the positions that the administration has been taking in the past few months, essentially a full-blown assault on DEI," said Sonja Starr, a professor of law at the University of Chicago.

The policy could particularly rattle Northwestern University, already under intense federal pressure amid a \$790 million funding freeze. As administrators implement a range of cost-cutting measures, speculation has swirled about a possible deal with the White House to restore funds — and how that could reshape the school's future policies.

Unlike other elite institutions, Northwestern saw an increase in Black and Hispanic students after the end of affirmative action. Experts noted such a trend could draw increased scrutiny under Trump, even though proving race-conscious admissions with data alone isn't so simple.

"A lot of this newly collected data could lead to fairly quick allegations of racial discrimination when, in fact, identifying racial discrimination in admissions outcomes is a much more labor-intensive process," said Anthony Chen, a Northwestern associate professor of sociology.

Universities are already required to report data on their institutional characteristics through IPEDS, or the Integrated

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Chicago latest stop on Sanders tour

U.S. Sen. Bernie Sanders said in Chicago that his deeply rooted push for income equality, guaranteed health care and other policies meant to lift up the working class are not "radical" and they're "what the American people want." **Chicagoland, Page 3**

Revisiting Brown's Chicken massacre

Rick Kogan: Patrick Wohl's new book, "Something Big: The True Story of the Brown's Chicken Massacre, a Decade-Long Manhunt, and the Trials That Followed," is a sensitive and thoughtful journey back to that distant horror in a Palatine restaurant and how it continues to affect lives. **Arts & Living**



Gov. JB Pritzker speaks Monday in Chicago as city, state and federal leaders denounce President Donald Trump's possible military deployment into the city. **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

'Do not come,' Pritzker tells Trump on troops

President appears to waffle Monday on whether to send Guard to Chicago

By Dan Petrella,
Rick Pearson and Alice Yin
Chicago Tribune

President Donald Trump appeared to waver Monday on whether he would attempt to deploy National Guard troops to Chicago, saying Gov. JB Pritzker should be asking for the help — a request the second-term Democrat has made clear isn't forthcoming.

"We may wait. We may or may not. We may just go in and do it, which is probably what we should do," Trump said. "You know, I hate to barge in on a city and then be treated horribly by corrupt politicians and bad politicians like a guy like Pritzker," Trump added, mocking the Illinois governor's weight and labeling him "a disaster."

Following the president's comments, Pritzker indeed made

it clear he wasn't inviting Trump to send the National Guard.

"Earlier today, in the Oval Office, Donald Trump looked at the assembled cameras and asked for me personally to say, 'Mr. President, can you do us the honor of protecting our city?'" Pritzker said during a news conference overlooking the Chicago River downtown. "Instead, I say: 'Mr. President, do not come to Chicago.'"

Emphasizing that there is no ongoing emergency that would justify deploying the Guard, the governor said such an action

would infringe on Illinois' sovereignty.

"This is exactly the type of overreach that our country's founders warned against, and it's the reason that they established a federal system with a separation of powers built on checks and balances," Pritzker said.

Still, Pritzker and other officials acknowledged there are few, if any, steps the city or state could take to head off a deployment if the president were to choose that route.

Turn to Troops, Page 2

Israel calls hospital attack 'mishap'

Journalists, rescuers among 20 killed in Gaza facility strikes

By Wafaa Shurafa,
Samy Magdy
and Sam Metz
Associated Press

DEIR AL-BALAH, Gaza Strip — Israel struck one of the main hospitals in the Gaza Strip on Monday and then hit the facility again as journalists and rescue workers rushed to the scene, killing at least 20 people and wounding scores more, local health workers said.

It was among the deadliest of several Israeli strikes that have hit both hospitals and journalists over the course of the 22-month war sparked by Hamas' Oct. 7, 2023, attack, and the assault came as Israel plans to widen its offensive to heavily populated areas.

Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu's office said the strike on Nasser Hospital in the southern city of Khan Younis was a "tragic mishap" and that the military was investigating.

The first strike hit an upper floor housing operating rooms and doctors' residences, killing at least two people, said Zaher al-Waheidi, head of the records department at the Gaza Health

Turn to Attack, Page 4



Skydivers descend during a failed attempt to break the 250-way state record on Friday at Skydive Chicago in Ottawa. **DOMINIC DI PALERMO/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

They jump out of planes for fun — and broke a skydiving record in the process

By Kalen Lumpkins
Chicago Tribune

OTTAWA, Ill. — Jumping from a plane, not ideal right? Well, the divers at Skydive Chicago would tell you it's an experience everyone needs to have.

The skydivers met last week for the first time in three years to attempt record-breaking dives. More than 450 people flew out of their planes into different formations in sizes the world hadn't previously seen.

Divers flew from 19,000

feet up headfirst, mimicking a Superman flight as they shot toward the ground at 180 mph in a group of 200. They had just 60 seconds to form a predetermined snowflake, unlink hands and deploy their parachutes. Another 250 skydivers coordinated to break the 250-way Illinois state record, one where divers flew parallel to the surface.

Skydive Chicago owner Rook Nelson led the efforts. His skydiving lineage started with his grandfather, who was in the U.S. Army's 82nd Airborne Divi-

sion. The stories Nelson's father heard motivated him to skydive at 16 and start his own school. Then it was Nelson's turn.

"I don't know exactly how the story goes, but they tossed me out of an airplane when I was 4 years old," Nelson said. "I did a couple jumps as a little child, and then I started jumping in 1994 at the age of 14. You couldn't keep me out of the airplane."

He's 27,000 jumps into his skydiving career and loves it

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